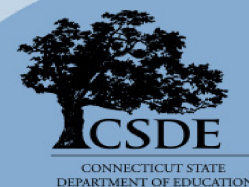


Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2022-23



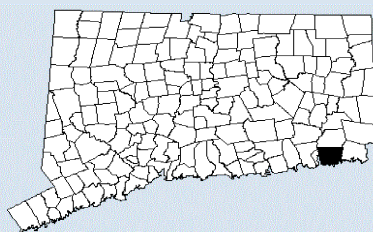
Groton School District

Ms. Susan Austin, Superintendent • 860-572-2100 • <https://www.grotonschools.org/>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	10
Enrollment	4,104
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$18,980
Total Expenditures ¹	\$84,708,911

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2021-22 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

Contents

Students.....	1
Educators.....	2
Instruction and Resources.....	2
Performance and Accountability.....	4
Narratives.....	7

Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2022-23 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2022 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	*	*	48.4
Male	2,125	51.8	51.5
Non-Binary	*	*	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	29	0.7	0.3
Asian	239	5.8	5.2
Black or African American	313	7.6	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	993	24.2	30.0
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	18	0.4	0.1
Two or More Races	520	12.7	4.5
White	1,992	48.5	47.5
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	159	3.9	9.7
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	1,830	44.6	42.4
Students with Disabilities ³	793	19.3	17.1

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	*	*	*	*
Male	437	22.0	228	10.1
Non-Binary	*	*	*	*
Black or African American	73	24.9	57	16.7
Hispanic or Latino of any race	277	28.5	110	10.1
White	309	17.1	124	6.0
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	48	27.3	17	8.9
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	547	28.2	248	11.4
Students with Disabilities	226	30.6	97	10.3
District	836	21.8	356	8.1
State		20.0		7

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 1,162

Number of school-based arrests: Fewer than 6

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

Groton School District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	284.2
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	74.6
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	64.5
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	148.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	9.0
School Level	23.9
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	8.5
Support Staff	2.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	32.0
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	36.7
School Nurses	8.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	275.0

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	8	1.7	1.3
Black or African American	19	4.1	4.6
Hispanic or Latino of any race	12	2.6	4.9
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	2	0.4	0.2
White	422	91.1	88.7

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2021-22

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	16.7	13.2

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	16	*	18	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	53	91.4	48	88.9
White	109	93.2	118	95.9
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	7	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	89	92.7	99	91.7
Students with Disabilities	27	84.4	51	91.1
District	220	92.8	220	93.6
State		86.5		94.2

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	50	43.9
Emotional Disability	24	41.4
Intellectual Disability	6	20.0
Learning Disability	233	82.9
Other Health Impairment	79	71.2
Other Disabilities	10	37.0
Speech/Language Impairment	55	93.2
District	457	67.2
State		68.6

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

Groton School District

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	122	2.9	2.4
Emotional Disability	58	1.4	1.0
Intellectual Disability	30	0.7	0.6
Learning Disability	281	6.7	6.3
Other Health Impairment	112	2.7	3.4
Other Disabilities	80	1.9	1.1
Speech/Language Impairment	71	1.7	1.9
All Disabilities	754	17.9	16.7

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	50	6.6	8.1
Private Schools or Other Settings	20	2.7	4.7

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2021-22

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$47,007,221	\$10,533	\$12,671
Support services - students	\$13,404,513	\$3,276	\$1,558
Support services - instruction	\$1,896,286	\$463	\$837
Support services - general administration	\$2,730,258	\$667	\$463
Support services - school based administration	\$4,503,701	\$1,101	\$1,133
Central and other support services	\$1,749,060	\$427	\$716
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$7,291,455	\$1,782	\$1,893
Student transportation services	\$6,126,416	\$1,497	\$1,464
Food services	.	.	\$5
Enterprise operations	.	.	\$186
Total	\$84,708,911	\$18,980	\$20,165

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2021-22

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$8,511,158	37.9	29.0
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$3,087,479	13.7	10.6
Other Salaries	\$1,219,572	5.4	10.1
Employee Benefits	\$1,859,248	8.3	13.1
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$1,434,158	6.4	5.9
Special Education Tuition	\$3,828,143	17.0	21.8
Supplies	\$296,488	1.3	0.7
Property Services	\$1,097	0.0	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$2,197,372	9.8	8.1
Equipment	\$41,098	0.2	0.2
All Other Expenditures	\$1,700	0.0	0.1
Total	\$22,477,514	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		26.5	24.9

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2021-22

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	61.5
State	31.8
Federal	6.6
Tuition & Other	0.0

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

Groton School District

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	12	*	12	*	6	*
Asian	111	75.8	111	75.1	46	67.5
Black or African American	145	55.6	144	45.9	52	48.1
Hispanic or Latino of any race	475	58.1	469	52.4	184	53.7
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	10	*	10	*	6	*
Two or More Races	217	62.2	217	56.3	90	58.4
White	952	69.0	950	64.7	394	66.8
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	106	56.3	106	53.1	38	55.8
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	1,816	65.4	1,807	60.2	740	61.8
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	931	58.2	922	52.9	365	55.6
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	991	71.1	991	66.3	413	66.7
Students with Disabilities	340	44.8	336	39.1	116	40.7
Students without Disabilities	1,582	69.2	1,577	64.3	662	65.1
High Needs	1,093	57.3	1,083	52.2	424	54.4
Non-High Needs	829	74.9	830	69.9	354	69.9
District	1,922	64.9	1,913	59.9	778	61.5

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	83.5	70.8	83.9	86.1	1,086	80.8
Curl Up	77.4	68.0	84.0	90.8	1,089	79.5
Push Up	57.9	58.1	69.8	76.5	1,090	65.0
Mile Run/PACER	75.2	49.0	32.1	56.3	1,079	52.9
All Tests - District	46.4	27.7	28.6	50.4	1,073	37.6
All Tests - State	51.5	46.0	44.1	41.1		45.5

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

Groton School District

Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2021-22	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	19	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	52	84.6
White	144	91.7
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	12	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	132	86.4
Students with Disabilities	49	67.3
District	264	89.8
State		88.9

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2021-22 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Participation ⁴	Meeting Benchmark	
	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	*	115	50.4
Male	93.8	100	41.2
Non-Binary	*	0	*
Black or African American	86.8	9	23.7
Hispanic or Latino	93.8	28	25.0
White	95.0	136	56.7
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	92.2	56	27.5
Students with Disabilities	77.3	*	*
District	94.7	215	45.6
State	95.2		44.3

³Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

⁴Participation Rate equals the number of test-takers in 11th and 12th grade divided by the number of students enrolled in those grades, as a percentage.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

Copyright © 2023 The College Board. www.collegeboard.org

ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

Copyright © 2023 ACT, Inc. www.act.org

IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

Copyright © International Baccalaureate Organization 2023

College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2022	Class of 2021
	Entrance ⁵ Rate (%)	Persistence ⁶ Rate (%)
Female	75.7	89.0
Male	52.1	90.7
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	42.6	*
White	68.4	91.8
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	51.6	88.0
Students with Disabilities	20.5	*
District	62.3	89.8
State	66.1	87.7

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

Groton School District

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	64.9	75	43.2	50	86.5	63.9
	High Needs Students	57.3	75	38.2	50	76.3	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	59.9	75	39.9	50	79.8	59.7
	High Needs Students	52.2	75	34.8	50	69.6	48.9
Science Performance Index	All Students	61.5	75	41.0	50	81.9	61.6
	High Needs Students	54.4	75	36.3	50	72.5	51.1
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	52.3%	100%	52.3	100	52.3	57.2%
	High Needs Students	48.5%	100%	48.5	100	48.5	52.5%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	55.6%	100%	55.6	100	55.6	61.8%
	High Needs Students	50.9%	100%	50.9	100	50.9	55.5%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	55.0%	100%	27.5	50	55.0	55.3%
	Oral	52.6%	100%	26.3	50	52.6	56.1%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	21.8%	<=5%	16.5	50	33.0	20.0%
	High Needs Students	27.8%	<=5%	4.5	50	8.9	28.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	93.2%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	90.4%
	% Meeting Benchmark	45.6%	75%	30.4	50	60.7	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		92.1%	94%	49.0	50	98.0	82.4%
4-year Graduation All Students (2022 Cohort)		89.8%	94%	95.5	100	95.5	88.9%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2020 Cohort)		80.4%	94%	85.6	100	85.6	85.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2022)		62.3%	75%	83.1	100	83.1	66.1%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		90.8% 37.6%	75%	25.0	50	50.1	93.0% 45.5%
Arts Access		62.2%	60%	50.0	50	100.0	54.5%
Accountability Index				983.9	1450	67.9	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					Y
ELA Performance Index Gap	74.9	57.3	17.6	16.6	
Math Performance Index Gap	69.9	52.2	17.7	18.0	
Science Performance Index Gap	69.9	54.4	15.5	17.8	
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	80.4%	13.6%	8.7%	Y

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	98.2
	High Needs Students	97.6
Math	All Students	97.6
	High Needs Students	96.5
Science	All Students	97.4
	High Needs Students	96.6

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: 48.8 State: 49.6

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

Groton School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Groton Public Schools realized the Groton 2020 plan with the opening of one new middle school, Groton Middle School, ensuring excellence and equity for all middle school students 2020-2021. As part of the plan with the State of Connecticut to ensure racial and socioeconomic balance at all Groton schools, two new elementary schools were built on the sites of the former two middle schools. At the same time, our elementary schools prepared and planned for a magnet option for students in Groton with the rollout of a lottery process and preparation to move relocated students and staff from the six schools into five. In September 2021, we opened our two new elementary schools, while closing three vintage elementary schools and creating an all intra-district elementary magnet program, for all five elementary schools in Groton.

A continued goal for Groton Public Schools (GPS) for FY23 was to reduce chronic absenteeism related to some of the residual effects of the pandemic including COVID-19 breakthrough cases, susceptibility to other illnesses such as the flu and RSV, and heightened mental health challenges. We continue to focus on Social Emotional learning for students and adults. Another major goal was to accelerate learning for all students, while filling any gaps made by interrupted education over the past couple of years. Funds were used to review and revise our Core Instruction and Tiered intervention process related to social emotional learning as well as academic learning. GPS continues our work with Responsive Classroom, Life is Good, Bibliotherapy, Restorative Practices, and Second Step. As part of our social emotional goal, Groton has established a Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion committee to look closely at hiring practices, data analysis, bias training, and books studies such as Unconscious Bias in Schools; A Developmental Approach to Exploring Race and Racism by Benson and Fiarman.

The superintendent reports on the district's work with diversity, equity, and inclusion. In partnership with Dr. Sonja Cherry-Paul, Dr. Kim Parker from Disrupt Text, and Cornelius Minor, the district is providing embedded coaching for all teachers and staff PK-12. Jemal Davis, Assistant Principal of Groton Middle School, leads the district's Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI) Committee with over 100 members that includes workgroups examining Data, Professional Learning, and Hiring Practices. Along with the Human Resources Department, we are reviewing our Diversity Hiring Plan, and looking to find additional high quality education candidates that mirror our community. Groton's Board of Education embraces this plan, which is embedded in its goals, "In a Richness of Cultures and With a Respect for all"€ .

Continuing our good work with academics in both the Core instruction and SRBI tiered intervention model, funds are used to provide district wide curriculum review, evaluation, and professional development related to the Connecticut Core and NGSS Standards Initiative in ELA, Math, Science and Social Studies. Professional development will continue to include virtual webinar sessions to provide engaging instruction with the use of technology. By using excellent staff developers, such as Columbia University's Teachers College Readers and Writers Project, Project Oceanography, CREC, and LEARN, our goal is to provide support for teaching and learning.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

Groton schools continues to work to ensure that our students receive an education, which enables them to interact with teachers and students from diverse racial, ethnic, and economic backgrounds.

In the spring of 2020, the Groton Board of Education responded to the social unrest caused by the killing of George Floyd by initiating a district-wide Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion Committee. The 100-person group developed a five-year program to address issues of systemic racism and to promote equity for all members of the educational community. During the 2020-2021 school year, over one hundred teachers and administrators participated in the district DEI Committee that was responsible for planning a facilitating professional learning, book clubs, data collection, policy review, and the lifting of student voice. All faculty and staff were involved in the experience and the BOE recognized and approved the DEI vision statement for Groton Public Schools. We now have this initiative in our operating budget with a stipend position for a DEI coordinator, that was hired in 2021.

In Groton Public Schools, where 51% of the students are eligible for free and reduced lunch, all students were provided a school nutrition program, and the district continued implementing a one-to-one Chromebook initiative, with hotspots as needed, to provide computer access for all students.

Other opportunities to offer enriching and diverse experience for our student population included student trips to the Mystic Seaport, the Mystic Aquarium, Project Oceanology, NESS, The Mystic Art Museum, the Eastern Connecticut Symphony Orchestra, The Nautilus Museum, to name a few, as well as our continued partnering with the U.S. Naval Submarine Base and use of its resources.

Fitch High School students participated remotely in a regional diversity program called More Than Words. The program engages students from New London High School, Ledyard High School and students from the Mashantucket Pequot Tribal Nation in a year-long workshop designed to promote respect for diversity and develop skills in conflict resolution.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

Groton School District

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

The Groton Board of Education's policy concerning the annual distribution of resources ensures that each of the seven schools in the district receives an adequate level of material, supplies, and personnel to implement and execute educational programs. Funding is based on student enrollment, district-wide educational programs, and the unique needs of its students, commensurate with district goals and available resources to ensure equity and address needs. Groton Public Schools addresses equity concerns and outreach so that all students and families have access and benefit from these programs. The district will ensure that barriers, such as gender, race, national origin, color, disability, age, socio-economics or others, will not prevent students, families, teachers, and staff from access or participation in these programs: Support engaging instruction; provide effective assessments that assist a teacher in monitoring student achievement while informing his/her instruction; Raise the rigor and relevance of instruction, especially using tenets of culturally relevant and responsive pedagogy; Lay the foundation for Access and Equity through International Baccalaureate programming.